



James Macmillan

Cover Letter

Hey, I'm James, a Senior Software Engineer based in the Midlands, and I appreciate you taking the time to review my CV.

I'm currently seeking full-time remote opportunities as a Senior Developer. With over 10 years of commercial web development experience and more than 5 years building cross-platform mobile applications, I bring a deep and well-rounded skill set to any team.

Over the past two years, have built and operated multiple production applications across both AWS and GCP, gaining solid cross-cloud experience in real-world environments.

My preferred stack includes Node.js or .NET Core on the backend, paired with React and Tailwind on the frontend. That said, I've worked extensively across a broad range of frontend and server-side technologies, and I'm quick to adapt where needed.

I started building for the web at age 12, growing my skills alongside the evolution of the web itself — from desktop to mobile and beyond. Today, I specialise in full-stack development within the JavaScript ecosystem, but I also bring experience in a wide range of team environments, workflows, and technical architectures.

I'd be a strong addition to any dev team looking for a seasoned, pragmatic engineer with a passion for clean code, great UX, and effective collaboration.

Thanks again for your time,

James Macmillan



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Email

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Address

Midlands, UK.



Availability

Immediate



Seeking

Full time, remote roles in the UK.

This CV was written with ♥ in the Midlands, Using  Vite,  React,  Tailwind & others.

Experience

Profile

Agile, Full Stack Developer with team leadership, presentation, design, UX/UI, and application architectural experience.

Passionate and articulate, with proven knowledge in all aspects of Hybrid Mobile and Progressive Web app development.

Experienced in developing mobile and web applications across the extended full-stack, with teams of developers at varying levels of experience.

A strong love of technology, solving complex business problems with a team of like-minded people.

Songtradr

Mar '23 - Present



Ingesting the world's music one release at a time.

Joined the Media Delivery and Ingestion team, where I worked on building and maintaining large-scale, serverless applications that handled the ingestion, processing, and global distribution of music and metadata. I contributed to re-platforming key parts of the output pipeline, including pricing logic and global availability handling, and helped implement a scalable document store to support responsive release ingestion.

The role gave me deep exposure to fast-paced, pragmatic development using XP practices and TDD. The team focused on using the right tool for the job, delivering robust, high-performance solutions while cutting unnecessary complexity and waste. We made it a priority to empower business users with fast, reliable access to the data they needed, supporting both internal goals and growing client demands.

Engineius

Jul '20 - Feb '23



Overhauling, updating, and improving Mobile and Web apps.

I was tasked with overhauling the Engineius mobile app, while transitioning its development in house. I significantly improved the performance, UX/UI, stability and maintainability of the app. I also worked to significantly improve the architecture and performance of the company's main web app.

I delivered multiple business derived projects working closely with the end users involved. I also lead and mentored new employees on the mobile app's development.

Packt

Nov '17 - Jan '20



Shipping the mobile app for the Subscription platform and going Serverless.

I worked with Packt for 2 years on the Subscription platform. I was initially hired to expand the web application into a cross platform mobile app. I was also instrumental in migrating the API to use the Serverless framework on AWS. I worked with a team of developers with varying skill sets, helping to upskill and train new members of the team.

My development career became very focussed on Javascript stacks, writing brilliant code to solve complex solutions on a variety of platforms. During my time with Packt I endeavoured to improve code quality across the stack, helping develop and implement the code style used in house.

Severn Trent

Sep '12 - Oct '17



Delivering web and mobile apps to drive the business forward.

Skills

Stacks

My Ideal working stack is Node.js on Lambdas, or in Containers. With a modern RDS & Object Store. On the front end I like working in React or another component-based flux framework, with Tailwind and a decent bundler. On mobile I like Ionic but I'm currently transitioning to React Native.

In the recent past I've worked on more traditional stacks, deploying Node & .net core APIs to AWS on containers, EC2 instances as well as lambdas. I've also worked with multiple static site and SSR deployment patterns. My last few roles have used Angular heavily so I've got tonnes of Angular experience.

Interests

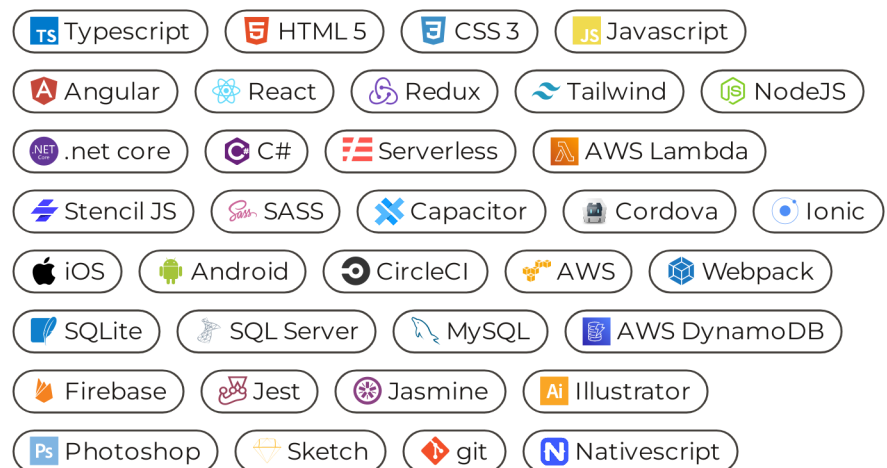
I'm a keen photographer, avid reader, and Cyclist. I find my interests changing over time but the main few stay the same.

When I'm not working, I like to continuously learn. In the last few years I've taken up Game Programming, Machine Learning, and Data Science. I find that learning new paradigms and languages keeps me sharp.

Below you will find a summary of some of the key technologies and tooling that I have experience with. If you would like to know if I've used a particular technology that's not listed, please get in touch.

Over the last decade I've picked up a wealth of experience in web and mobile application development. This has lead to lots of experience with UX/UI Design, Unit Testing, CI/CD, Software Architecture, DBMS, Performance Optimisation, and more.

Throughout my career I have mentored and lead other developers of varying skill levels. I've worked in a variety of teams with a variety of processes, and I'm most comfortable with Agile methodologies.



Education

Coventry University

Jan '09 - Jan '12

BSc Computer Science *G400, 2.1 with Honors*

Caroline Chisholm School

Jan '02 - Jan '09

3 A Levels *Including Computing*
11 GCSEs

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Projects

2021

Portal Architecture

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 Typescript

 .net core

 Angular

Updated the Web Portal's architecture to split front end and api.

The customer facing web portal was serving via. an old Angular .net core template's architecture. Each client route returned an angular app as a page.

In this project I extracted the front end Angular apps into their own project, bootstrapped webpack and switched all routing to the angular front end. This involved overhauling routing, the webpack build, and the angular project as a whole.

As a part of this project I also identified that the vendor bundle had been misconfigured, serving node_module dependencies twice. Fixing this, implementing Lazy Loaded routing and separating the front end server from the back-end server resulted in significant performance improvements.

This also had a significant impact on development turnover, prior to these changes the rebuild cycle was well over a minute on most developer's machines.

2020

Mobile App

Engineius

Bringing a third party development in house

Engineius originally outsourced their app development as is common in early startup phase. This project involved bringing the functioning production app development in house and up to a long term maintainable standard.

My initial work here was to take stock, and roughly plan the necessary changes to ensure long term maintenance. There was also a looming deadline of an iOS upgrade deprecating the old Web View.

I started by implementing some node best practices; dependency pinning, auto formatting & linting with CI layer build checks. I then upgraded the underlying frameworks to their latest stable versions, this included bringing Nativescript to v7+ and Angular to 12+. As these were significant major version releases there was lots of in depth analysis and retest work along with the development.

Once this work was complete and functioning I then focused on outstanding production app issues. In particular there were multiple memory leaks, performance drags and the app's styling had not been completed or branded.